

COVE DUBAI

Website · Booking System · Admin Panel

Project Proposal & Technical Specification

Prepared by



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1. Executive Summary

Cove Dubai is a 106-room boutique luxury hotel currently under construction in Dubai. This proposal covers the complete digital foundation required for launch: a brand-led marketing website, a bespoke guest-facing booking system, and a hotel admin panel for managing rooms, rates, availability, and reservations.

The hotel has indicated a future intention to operate IDS Next as its Property Management System (PMS). This is a sound long-term choice - IDS Next is an enterprise-grade hospitality platform with verified DTCM integration, trusted by major hotel groups across the UAE.

However, since IDS Next has not yet been contracted and the hotel is still under construction, the recommended approach is to build a clean, lightweight custom system at launch - and engineer it specifically so that the IDS Next integration in Phase 2 is straightforward, well-defined, and low-risk.

The core principle of this engagement

Build a solid foundation now that works independently at launch. Design it so that connecting IDS Next later is a clearly defined integration task - not a rebuild. Every architecture decision in Phase 1 is made with Phase 2 in mind.

What this engagement delivers

- ▶ Marketing website - Home, About, Rooms, Reserve - built to the Cove Dubai design mockups
- ▶ Bespoke guest booking flow - live availability, room selection, guest details, confirmation
- ▶ Hotel admin panel - manage rooms, rates, availability calendar, and reservations
- ▶ Direct booking engine - commission-free reservations via the hotel's own website
- ▶ Bilingual website - English and Arabic with full RTL layout support
- ▶ IDS Next integration roadmap - a clear technical specification of exactly what Phase 2 requires

What is not in this engagement

- ▶ IDS Next subscription or setup - hotel operational decision and cost
- ▶ OTA channel manager (Booking.com, Expedia, Agoda) - Phase 2, handled by IDS Next
- ▶ Online payment gateway - pay at check-in model at launch

2. System Architecture

The system is built in two phases with a clean handover point between them. Phase 1 is fully functional and independent. Phase 2 replaces the custom reservation layer with IDS Next - without touching the website or booking flow the guest sees.

Phase 1 Architecture - Launch System

Layer	What it does	Built by
Marketing website	Public-facing pages - Home, About, Rooms, Reserve flow. Pixel-perfect to Cove Dubai mockups.	Bandi
Booking flow	Guest-facing reservation journey. Queries live availability. Posts confirmed bookings. Sends confirmation emails.	Bandi

Layer	What it does	Built by
Booking API	Thin server-side layer sitting between the booking flow and the database. This is the layer IDS Next replaces in Phase 2.	Bandi
Custom database	Stores room types, rates, availability, and reservations. PostgreSQL. Structured to mirror IDS Next's data model for easy migration.	Bandi
Admin panel	Hotel staff interface - room management, rate setting, availability calendar, reservations dashboard.	Bandi

Why a custom database now, not a third-party PMS?

IDS Next has not been contracted yet and the hotel is not open. Subscribing to an enterprise PMS before the hotel is operational means paying 12–24 months of subscription fees with no guests. The custom system costs a one-time build fee, gives the hotel full control during pre-opening, and is designed to hand off cleanly to IDS Next when the time is right.

Phase 2 Architecture - IDS Next Integration

When the hotel is ready to onboard IDS Next, the integration replaces the custom booking API and database with the IDS Next FX Front Office system. The website and guest-facing booking flow require minimal changes - the integration is behind the scenes.

Layer	Phase 1	Phase 2 (IDS Next)
Marketing website	No change required	No change required
Guest booking flow	Minor updates to connect to IDS Next API	Powered by IDS Next FX API
Booking API layer	Custom - replaced in Phase 2	IDS Next FX Front Office
Room & rate management	Custom admin panel	IDS Next native admin
Availability engine	Custom database logic	IDS Next real-time inventory
Reservations	Custom database	IDS Next reservation system
DTCM reporting	Manual export (basic)	IDS Next verified DTCM export
Tourism Dirham	Configured manually	IDS Next auto-calculation
OTA distribution	Not available	IDS Next channel manager

The website and guest booking experience the client sees in the mockups does not change when IDS Next is connected. The integration happens entirely in the backend API layer.

3. IDS Next - Why It Is the Right Future Choice

IDS Next FX Front Office is an enterprise-grade cloud PMS with a strong regional footprint across the UAE and Middle East. It is the correct long-term operational platform for Cove Dubai. Here is why it is the right choice for Phase 2, and why Phase 2 - not Phase 1 - is the right time to bring it in.

What IDS Next brings in Phase 2

- ▶ **Verified DTCM compliance** - IDS Next marketplace explicitly lists a certified DTCM Export interface - confirmed direct integration with Dubai's tourism authority reporting system. This is Tier 1 compliance, the highest available.
- ▶ **Tourism Dirham automation** - Applied automatically to guest folios per room night. No manual calculation by front-desk staff.
- ▶ **UAE VAT invoicing** - UAE VAT applied correctly to accommodation charges and shown on guest tax invoices.
- ▶ **OTA channel manager** - Connects to SiteMinder, RateTiger, STAAH, D-Edge, and others - all capable of syncing Booking.com, Expedia, and Agoda in real time.
- ▶ **Enterprise reliability** - Trusted by Wyndham, Radisson, and Marriott-affiliated properties. Operating across 300,000+ rooms in 50+ countries.
- ▶ **Regional support** - UAE-based implementation and support team. Used across Dubai, Abu Dhabi, and Ajman - statutory interfaces confirmed for all three emirates.

What needs to happen before IDS Next integration (Phase 2 prerequisites)

- ▶ IDS Next FX Front Office subscription contracted and activated
- ▶ IDS Next account manager provides API credentials and integration documentation
- ▶ API protocol confirmed - IDS Next uses HTNG-based integration; technical specification reviewed before Phase 2 is quoted
- ▶ Channel manager selected from IDS Next marketplace (SiteMinder or RateTiger recommended for Dubai)
- ▶ Hotel DET registration completed
- ▶ Data migration plan agreed - existing reservations from Phase 1 database migrated to IDS Next

Important: IDS Next API access requires a partner agreement

IDS Next does not offer self-serve API access. Connecting a bespoke booking flow to FX Front Office requires their integration team to issue credentials and documentation. This process typically takes 2–4 weeks after the subscription is active. Phase 2 timeline should account for this vendor onboarding period.

4. Detailed Scope of Work - Phase 1

4.1 Marketing Website

Five pages built pixel-perfect to the Cove Dubai design mockups. Fully responsive, performance-optimised, SEO-ready.

- ▶ **Home** - Hero, hotel introduction, featured rooms, amenities, call-to-action.
- ▶ **About** - Brand story, property overview, location.
- ▶ **Rooms** - Room type listings with photography, descriptions, key features, Reserve CTAs.
- ▶ **Reserve - Step 1** - Date picker with live availability check. Guest count selector.
- ▶ **Reserve - Step 2** - Available rooms for selected dates. Pricing, selection, booking summary.
- ▶ **Confirmation** - Guest details form, booking submission, automated confirmation email.
- ▶ Mobile-first responsive across all screen sizes
- ▶ Core Web Vitals optimised - LCP under 2.5s, CLS under 0.1

- ▶ SEO foundations - meta tags, Open Graph, Hotel schema markup, sitemap
- ▶ SSL, HTTPS, secure headers

4.2 Bespoke Booking Flow

The guest reservation journey, built to the Reserve flow mockups, powered by the custom booking API.

- ▶ **Availability check** - Queries live room inventory for selected dates. Displays available room types with pricing.
- ▶ **Room selection** - Guest selects room type. Price per night and total stay shown clearly.
- ▶ **Guest details** - Name, email, phone, special requests. No online payment - pay at check-in model.
- ▶ **Confirmation** - Reservation written to database. Unique booking reference generated. Confirmation email sent to guest and hotel automatically.
- ▶ **Cancellation** - Guest can cancel via email link. Hotel admin can cancel or modify from the admin panel.
- ▶ Concurrency protection - prevents two guests booking the same room simultaneously
- ▶ Session persistence - booking progress saved if guest navigates away
- ▶ Error states - clear messaging for unavailable dates, failed submissions, network errors
- ▶ WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility compliance on all form inputs

4.3 Hotel Admin Panel

A dedicated web-based admin interface for hotel staff. Secure login, role-based access. All reservation data in one place.

Feature	Detail
Room type management	Add, edit, delete room types. Set descriptions, capacity, amenities, photos.
Rate management	Set base nightly rate per room type. Seasonal rate overrides. Minimum stay rules.
Availability calendar	Visual month/week calendar. Block individual dates. Mark rooms as unavailable. View occupancy at a glance.
Reservations dashboard	All bookings in one view. Filter by date, status, room type. Search by guest name or reference.
Booking detail view	Guest name, contact, dates, room, special requests, booking reference, status.
Booking management	Confirm, modify, cancel bookings. Add internal notes. Mark as checked-in / checked-out.
Guest notification	Trigger confirmation or cancellation email to guest from admin panel.
Basic reporting	Occupancy by date range. Upcoming arrivals and departures. Revenue summary.
Secure login	Admin-only access. Password protected. Session timeout for security.

4.4 Arabic Language & RTL Support

Dubai's guest profile is international, with a significant proportion of Arabic-speaking guests from the UAE and wider GCC. The website and booking flow will be delivered in both English and Arabic, with full right-to-left (RTL) layout support.

- ▶ **Bilingual website** - All five public pages delivered in English and Arabic. Language toggle accessible from the header on every page.

- ▶ **RTL layout** - Arabic version uses a fully mirrored layout - navigation, content flow, form inputs, and booking steps all correctly right-to-left. No shortcuts with CSS transforms; proper RTL implementation.
- ▶ **Arabic booking flow** - Date picker, room selection, guest details form, and confirmation page all rendered and validated correctly in Arabic. Confirmation emails sent in the guest's selected language.
- ▶ **Arabic admin panel** - Hotel staff can switch the admin interface to Arabic. All room names, descriptions, and guest-facing content manageable in both languages from one panel.
- ▶ **Typography** - Arabic content uses a high-quality Arabic web font (e.g. Almarai or Cairo) selected to complement the Cove Dubai brand aesthetic. English and Arabic fonts are paired for visual consistency.
- ▶ **SEO - Arabic** - Arabic pages carry correct hreflang tags (ar and en), Arabic meta titles and descriptions, and are indexed separately by search engines - capturing Arabic-language hotel searches in Dubai and the GCC.

Arabic content - translations for all room descriptions, About page, and UI labels - is a client responsibility. Professional translation is recommended; machine translation should not be used for a luxury brand.

4.5 IDS Next Integration Readiness

Every Phase 1 architectural decision is made with the IDS Next integration in mind. This is what makes Phase 2 a defined integration task rather than a rebuild.

- ▶ **Database schema** - Room types, rate plans, reservations, and guest records are structured to mirror IDS Next's data model. Migration scripts will be prepared as part of Phase 1 handover documentation.
- ▶ **Booking API layer** - The API sitting between the booking flow and the database is built as a standalone service with clean interfaces. In Phase 2, this layer is replaced by IDS Next API calls - the booking flow above it requires only minor endpoint updates.
- ▶ **Integration specification** - Phase 1 handover includes a written technical specification documenting exactly what the IDS Next integration requires - endpoints, data mapping, authentication, and migration steps. This becomes the Phase 2 brief.

5. Technical Best Practices

The following standards apply across all deliverables as non-negotiable baseline requirements - and are specifically chosen to make the future IDS Next integration clean and low-risk.

Security

- ▶ HTTPS enforced across all pages and API calls
- ▶ Admin panel protected by authenticated sessions with timeout
- ▶ All booking inputs validated and sanitised server-side
- ▶ CSRF protection on all form submissions
- ▶ Rate limiting on the booking API endpoint to prevent abuse
- ▶ Environment variables for all credentials - nothing hardcoded in source code

Data integrity

- ▶ PostgreSQL database with proper constraints - no orphaned records, no duplicate bookings
- ▶ Atomic transactions on booking writes - either the booking is fully saved or fully rolled back
- ▶ Audit log on all admin actions - who changed what and when
- ▶ Database backups - daily automated snapshots

Performance

- ▶ Core Web Vitals targets - LCP under 2.5s, CLS under 0.1, INP under 200ms
- ▶ Images served in WebP with lazy loading and responsive srcsets
- ▶ Availability queries optimised with database indexing on date and room type
- ▶ Static assets served from CDN

Maintainability & IDS Next readiness

- ▶ Clean separation between the booking flow (front-end), booking API (server), and database - matching the three-layer model IDS Next will slot into
- ▶ No business logic hardcoded in the front-end - all availability and pricing logic lives in the API layer
- ▶ Full API documentation produced at handover - any developer can maintain or extend it
- ▶ Git version control with deployment pipeline
- ▶ Staging environment for testing before any changes go live

6. Phased Delivery Plan

Phase 1 - Custom System (This engagement)

Week	Deliverable
Week 1–2	Database schema design (structured for IDS Next migration). Booking API architecture. Marketing website structure. Development environment and staging server set up.
Week 3–5	Marketing website built - all pages, responsive, SEO foundations. Admin panel - room management, rate setting, availability calendar.
Week 6–8	Bespoke booking flow - live availability, room selection, guest details, confirmation, email notifications. Admin reservations dashboard and booking management.
Week 9–10	Full end-to-end testing - booking accuracy, concurrency, error states, mobile, accessibility. Staging review with client. IDS Next integration specification document produced.
Week 10–11	Client review and revisions. Performance and security audit. DNS cutover and go-live.

Timeline assumes client provides final photography and room copy by end of Week 2. Content delays will extend the timeline.

Phase 2 - IDS Next Integration (Separate engagement, future)

Phase 2 begins when the hotel has contracted IDS Next and obtained API credentials. Estimated duration: 6–10 weeks depending on IDS Next API onboarding timeline.

Phase 2 Task	Complexity
IDS Next API partner agreement and credential setup	IDS Next side - allow 2–4 weeks
Replace custom booking API with IDS Next FX API calls	Medium - well-defined from Phase 1 spec
Update guest booking flow to use IDS Next endpoints	Low - minor front-end changes only
Migrate reservation data from custom DB to IDS Next	Medium - migration scripts prepared in Phase 1

Phase 2 Task	Complexity
Activate channel manager (Booking.com, Expedia, Agoda)	Low - PMS configuration, not custom code
Configure DTCM export and Tourism Dirham in IDS Next	Low - IDS Next native feature, staff training
Retire custom admin panel (staff move to IDS Next admin)	Low - staff onboarding and training

Phase 2 will be quoted separately

Phase 2 pricing and timeline will be agreed once IDS Next is contracted and their API documentation is in hand. The Phase 1 integration specification document produced at handover becomes the Phase 2 brief - reducing scoping time and risk significantly.

7. Client Responsibilities

The following items are outside the build scope but are required for the project to launch on schedule.

Item	Owner	Required by
Photography - all room types, common areas, exterior, lobby	Client	Week 2
Copy - About page, room descriptions, amenities, hotel story (English)	Client	Week 2
Arabic translations - all website copy, room descriptions, UI labels	Client	Week 3
Domain name and DNS access	Client	Week 1
Branded email for guest booking confirmations	Client	Week 3
DET / DTCM hotel registration (required before taking live bookings)	Client	Before go-live
Review and approval at staging milestone	Client	Week 9–10
IDS Next subscription (Phase 2 - when ready)	Client	Phase 2 start

8. Pricing

All pricing is in UAE Dirhams. The Phase 1 build fee is a one-time fixed cost. Hosting and domain are the hotel's ongoing operational costs.

Phase 1 - One-Time Build Fee

Phase 1 is a fixed-price engagement covering the marketing website, bespoke booking flow (English + Arabic/RTL), hotel admin panel, database design, IDS Next migration schema, testing, QA, and go-live support.

Deliverable
Marketing website - all pages, responsive, SEO foundations
Bespoke booking flow - availability engine, reservation journey, emails
Hotel admin panel - rooms, rates, availability, reservations dashboard
Database design and IDS Next migration schema
IDS Next integration specification document (Phase 2 brief)
Testing, QA, accessibility, performance optimisation
Project management, staging, go-live support

Phase 1 - Complete Delivery	Pricing (AED)
Total fixed price - all deliverables included	18,000 AED

Payment Terms

Milestone	Amount	Due
Deposit - project kickoff	50% of total	Upon signing the engagement letter
Final payment - delivery	50% of total	Upon go-live and client sign-off

Work begins upon receipt of the deposit. The final payment is due upon delivery of the completed, live website and booking system. No work will commence without the signed engagement letter and deposit.

Ongoing - Hotel Operational Costs (not part of build fee)

Item	Est. Monthly Cost (AED)	Paid to
Hosting (VPS - website + API + database)	200 – 400	Railway

Phase 2 - IDS Next Integration (quoted separately)

Phase 2 will be scoped and priced as a separate engagement once IDS Next is contracted and API documentation is available.

IDS Next subscription cost is a separate hotel operational expense, paid directly to IDS Next. Pricing is enterprise and quote-based - request directly from your IDS Next account manager.

The Value Framing

OTAs charge 15–25% commission per booking. A 106-room boutique hotel at average Dubai occupancy can pass AED 150,000–250,000+ annually in OTA commissions. Once IDS Next and the channel manager are active in Phase 2, even converting 20–30% of OTA bookings to direct bookings recovers the entire project cost within the first operating year.

9. Next Steps

Action	Owner	When
Confirm go-live target date for the website	Client	This week
Review and approve this proposal	Client	This week
Sign engagement letter and initial payment	Client	Before Week 1 starts
Provide domain access	Client	Week 1
Brief IDS Next account manager - request Phase 2 API documentation timeline	Client	When hotel nears opening

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This proposal is valid for 30 days from the date of issue.